CLEARLEDGER BUSINESS SOLUTIONS

Service Operations & Management Visibility

Demonstration Consulting Case Study

Vertex Integrated Services Ltd.

Fictional scenario created to demonstrate ClearLedger's approach to data management, analysis, reporting and process improvement.

CASE THEME

The company had plenty of data, but not yet a reliable management-information system.

Capture → Control → Analyse → Report → Improve

Executive Summary

Vertex Integrated Services Ltd. is a fictional 65-person technical services company managing multiple clients, work orders, field teams, job costs, invoices and collections. The business had grown, but its reporting processes remained fragmented across separate operational and financial files.

ClearLedger was tasked with reviewing how management information was being captured, controlled, analysed and reported. The diagnostic found that the problem was not simply a lack of dashboards: several data-quality and information-control weaknesses could materially distort SLA, workforce, profitability and receivables reporting.

> **ClearLedger conclusion**
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> Before management could rely on a dashboard, the underlying information controls had to be strengthened. The engagement therefore followed a diagnose → remediate → analyse → report sequence rather than jumping directly to visualisation.

Key KPI picture after remediation

KPI	Result	Target / Reference
Billable Revenue	₦474.9m	Management view
Contribution Margin	₦111.5m	—
Contribution Margin %	23.5%	≥ 25%
Collection Rate	68.0%	≥ 90%
Outstanding Receivables	₦126.7m	—
Completed Work Orders	804	—
SLA Compliance	88.8%	≥ 90%
First-Time Resolution	87.1%	≥ 85%

1. Client Situation & Business Problem

Vertex provides preventive and corrective maintenance, facilities support, field technical services, equipment servicing and small installation works. Its clients operate under annual maintenance contracts, monthly retainers, call-out arrangements and project-based engagements.

The company had significant operational data, but the information was spread across separate work-order, timesheet, job-cost, invoice and receivables files. Monthly management reporting required manual consolidation and still did not answer several important questions quickly.

Management questions that were difficult to answer

- Which clients generate the strongest commercial value after considering cost-to-serve and collections?
- Which jobs and service types are exceeding expected cost or taking too long to resolve?
- Are teams genuinely capacity-constrained, or is workload distributed inefficiently?
- Which invoices and customers are driving the receivables exposure?
- Is revenue growth translating into contribution margin and cash?
- Which performance issues require management intervention now?

> **The visible symptom**
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> Management wanted clearer dashboards and reporting.

> **The deeper issue**
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> Several source-data and control weaknesses meant that simply visualising the existing information could have produced misleading management conclusions.

2. What ClearLedger Diagnosed

The initial review covered client master data, work orders, employees, timesheets, job costs, invoices/collections and target definitions. Twenty-two findings were documented and prioritised by severity and business impact.

Finding area	Examples	Business consequence
Record integrity	Duplicate work orders and timesheets	Could overstate workload, labour and job counts
Reference integrity	Invalid work-order references in timesheets and costs	Costs/hours could be assigned to nonexistent jobs
Classification control	Inconsistent team, service and cost-type labels	Splits one category across multiple reporting buckets
Workforce validation	Impossible daily-hour combinations	Distorts utilisation, overtime and labour cost
Receivables control	Payment status conflicts, overpayments, missing due dates	Misstates collections, ageing and follow-up priorities
Target logic	Direction/range not defined for some KPIs	Can classify poor performance as good performance

Diagnostic principle

> **Reliable insight starts with reliable information**
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> The diagnostic was not an exercise in cosmetic data cleaning. Each finding was tied to a reporting or decision risk and paired with a corrective action and a preventive control.

3. What ClearLedger Changed

The remediation stage separated safe corrections from records that required business confirmation. Raw source data was preserved, while analysis-ready tables and controlled reference structures were created separately.

Safe standardisation and control improvements

- Standardised service, team and cost-type classifications through controlled master lists.
- Derived client names from Client ID rather than relying on manually typed names.
- Calculated missing invoice due dates from invoice date and contractual payment terms where safe.
- Derived payment status from payment values and due dates rather than trusting manual status entry.
- Introduced controlled role/labour-rate logic and target-direction/range rules.
- Separated client status from contract status to reduce definition ambiguity.

Records quarantined rather than silently changed

- Duplicate work orders and timesheets requiring factual confirmation.
- Completed work orders with missing completion dates.
- Impossible or excessive timesheet-hour combinations.
- Invalid work-order references in timesheets and job costs.
- Negative costs without a documented reversal/credit reason.
- Potential duplicate cost transactions and invoice overpayments.

> **Control philosophy**
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> Where the facts were uncertain, ClearLedger did not invent values merely to make the data look complete. Ambiguous records were isolated for review so the analysis remained defensible.

4. What the Analysis Revealed

A. Cash conversion is the most urgent gap

Company-wide collection performance was approximately 68.0% against a 90% management target, leaving about ₦126.7 million outstanding. The immediate management priority is therefore not only to grow invoicing, but to improve cash conversion and follow-up on high-exposure accounts.

B. Revenue is not translating into the target contribution level

Contribution margin was approximately 23.5%, below the 25% target. The business therefore needs to distinguish high-revenue work from high-value work by considering labour, materials, transport, subcontractor cost and repeat service effort.

C. Largest client does not mean healthiest client

Client	Billable Revenue	Contribution Margin %	Collection Rate	Outstanding
Meridian Foods	≈ ₦52.4m	≈ 21.0%	≈ 45.3%	≈ ₦25.0m
NovaCare Hospitals	≈ ₦28.2m	≈ 24.5%	≈ 87.6%	≈ ₦3.3m

Meridian generated almost twice NovaCare's billable revenue, but its weaker collections and lower contribution profile made the account commercially less attractive than the headline revenue suggested.

D. Workforce pressure is a distribution problem, not simply a headcount problem

Team Bravo showed the highest overtime pressure and exceeded the 10% overtime target, while Team Delta had the highest overall utilisation. At the same time, all teams remained below the intended 75–85% utilisation range. That combination points toward workload distribution, scheduling, skill bottlenecks or time-capture quality before it points toward adding headcount.

E. Service performance is close to target but not uniform

First-time resolution was above target at approximately 87.1%, while SLA compliance was slightly below target at approximately 88.8%. The appropriate response is therefore targeted analysis by client, team and service type rather than treating service quality as one company-wide problem.

5. Management Recommendations

Priority	Recommended action	Management intent
1	Run an ageing-led receivables review focused on the largest outstanding clients, disputes, payment terms and accountable owners.	Improve cash conversion and reduce working-capital exposure.
2	Review low-margin clients and service categories before pursuing additional volume.	Improve the quality of revenue, not just the quantity.
3	Introduce client-value reviews combining revenue, margin, collections and service effort.	Avoid ranking clients on revenue alone.
4	Review Team Bravo job mix, skill coverage and scheduling before changing headcount.	Resolve localised overtime pressure using existing capacity where possible.
5	Isolate the specific clients/services driving SLA misses and address root causes.	Move from company-wide averages to targeted operational improvement.
6	Embed controlled master data, validation rules and exception monitoring before further automation.	Protect reporting reliability as the business scales.

Recommended reporting cadence

- Weekly: service exceptions, SLA misses, overdue work orders and critical receivables.
- Monthly: management pack covering commercial, operational, workforce and cash performance.
- Quarterly: client-value review and information-control health check.

6. Business Value Created

The demonstration case shows how ClearLedger moves beyond spreadsheet preparation or dashboard development. The value comes from connecting data control, business analysis and management reporting into one coherent information system.

ClearLedger capability	What changed in the case
Business Data Management	Fragmented source records were standardised, validated and separated into controlled analysis-ready structures.
Data Analysis & Business Insights	Commercial, operational, workforce and receivables information was connected to reveal issues that headline totals could not show.
Reporting & Business Intelligence	Management gained a KPI framework and dashboard structure centred on exceptions and decisions.
Automation & Process Improvement	The engagement identified where validation, derived fields and controlled reference data could reduce recurring manual reporting risk.

> **The transformation**
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> Raw records → controlled information → analysis → management visibility → action

What this case demonstrates

- A dashboard should not be the first response to unreliable information.
- Revenue, margin, collections and service effort need to be viewed together to understand client value.
- Data-quality controls are part of management reporting, not a separate technical exercise.
- A useful report should tell management what needs attention, not simply what happened.

ClearLedger methodology used

CAPTURE → CONTROL → ANALYSE → REPORT → IMPROVE

Demonstration Case Note

Vertex Integrated Services Ltd. is a fictional business created for ClearLedger portfolio demonstration. The scenario, records and analysis are synthetic and are intended to demonstrate ClearLedger's consulting approach, not to represent a real client engagement.

> **ClearLedger positioning**
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> We help businesses get control of their information and use it to make better decisions.

Core belief

"Good records build great businesses."

ClearLedger Business Solutions works across business data management, analysis and insights, reporting and business intelligence, and automation/process improvement. The objective is to turn scattered or underused data into reliable information, clearer visibility and better decisions.